I Shouldn't Love You

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General Audiences

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I Shouldn't Love You

by Angst_And_Femboys

Summary

So, this is a modern AU where the Horde is a gang, the Princesses are rich, famous people who are not in charge (as opposed to rich, famous people who are in charge, which is what they kinda are in canon), there's no magic, and Adora is the tenant who eats cereal out of the bag. Catra and Scorpia are trying to kidnap Glimmer. They decide to do this at the large party Angella is hosting (rich people only, but two determined girls can do impossible things, at least in stories) - but things go a bit sideways. Now Catra's been captured, and has to find a way to escape - and hide her growing feelings for her captor, of all people.

Chapter 1

It was early morning in the giant, gleaming metropolis of Etheria. Though it was early, people already scurried along sidewalks as cars whizzed past them and neon signs blinked. The rising sun shone over all of it, even the run-down areas. In a small, shoddy apartment, an alarm beeped. A young woman groaned and slapped at her phone's screen, switching it off.

She got out of bed and dressed, in a pair of torn jeans and a red top. Her hand briefly went to the tattoo on her left wrist - a simple design that vaguely resembled demon wings. She'd never liked the thing, but it was there now, and she couldn't get it removed even if she could afford it - it was the symbol of the Horde, the gang she'd been in since she was fifteen. She shook her head to clear the memories away. She put her contact lenses into her heterochromatic eyes - one yellow eye, one blue - and went into the tiny living room.

A large woman with short white hair stared out the window, looking deep in thought. The first woman collapsed on the couch, face-down, catching the large woman's attention. She sat down beside the first woman.

"Good morning, Catra."

Catra groaned. "Morning, Scorpia," she said grudgingly.

"Look at the sunrise," Scorpia said, pointing out the window. "It's beautiful!"

"Whatever," Catra grumbled. "I hate it. I hate waking up early."

"You stayed up all night again?" Scorpia asked gently.

"I was trying to figure out how to pull off that kidnapping we're supposed to be doing," Catra snapped.

"Ohhhh. Oh, right. That rich girl, right? Glimmer Scott?"

Catra sat up and looked at her with a deadpan expression. "No, a different rich girl we have to kidnap."

"Who?" Scorpia asked, confused. "I thought it was just her. Is it, uh, Mermista Hunter? Or Perfuma Alexander? Please tell me it isn't her…"

Catra facepalmed. "That was sarcasm, Scorpia. But seriously, I hope we can pull this off. If we don't, Hordak will have our

heads."
"Mmm," Scorpia agreed. "So how are we gonna do that?"
Catra thought, then grinned. "Well, I heard that her family is throwing a party. So, we sneak into their big party next week, surprise that spoiled princess and take her hostage. They'll never see us coming."

On the other side of the city, in a large, comfortable apartment, another young woman was still asleep. A young man entered her bedroom. He realized she was still asleep, smiled, and opened the curtains on her window.
"Wake up, sleepy head!" he said, quietly but cheerfully. The woman groaned. "What time is it?" she mumbled. "It's seven!" he replied. "Time to wake up, the sun's waking up too!"
She groaned again. "Go away, Bow. Today's canceled." Bow folded his arms and grinned. "Glimmer…"
She sat up. "Fine. Get out of my room so I can change."
He left, and Glimmer dragged herself out of bed. She yanked a comb through her light pink hair and dressed in a pair of jean shorts and a purple top. When she left her room, Glimmer nearly walked right into Bow, who was standing right outside. "You know, sometimes I really regret convincing Mom to adopt you when we were kids," she grumbled. "Having an extra-peppy big brother isn't as awesome as it sounds."
"Aww, come on. We're best friends!" he said, smiling. Glimmer smiled back. "Yeah, we are."
They went downstairs to the huge kitchen, where a blonde woman their age was pouring milk directly into the cereal bag. "Hi guys," she said cheerfully, stirring the cereal and milk in the bag with a silver spoon. "Hi, Adora, " Glimmer said, smiling at her. Bow waved enthusiastically. "So?" Glimmer continued. "How's it feel to be a tenant in the house of a CEO and her kids?"
"Pretty cool," Adora said through a mouth full of cereal. "I still can't believe your mom is letting me stay here, and for way less money than most places worth living in cost."
"You know, she's only charging you at all to seem tough," Bow said. "She tries hard to seem intimidating, but once you get to know her, Mom's amazing."

"Yeah," Glimmer agreed. "You'll love her if you ever get to see her for more than ten minutes. Actually, we should ask her if you can go to the party she's hosting next week! I bet you'd love it!"
"Okay," Adora said, slightly excited. "We'll ask her next time she has a break!"
And they all continued to chat, blissfully unaware of the plot that would be put in motion at that party.

Chapter 2

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

A week later, it was the day of the party. Catra was pacing back and forth, waiting for Scorpia to emerge from the bedroom. The young Latin woman wore a dark red suit (very fancy and very stolen) with an untied bow tie. She had on the only pair of good shoes she owned, which she had shined to perfection the night before. Catra looked amazing.
The bedroom door opened and Scorpia emerged. She wore a floofy red dress, green eyeshadow and matching lipstick. "Yikes!" Catra exclaimed. Scorpia paused to stare at her. "You said a mean thing," the large woman said seriously. "You know what that means."
Her mouth stretched into a happy smile, and she searched in her purse before pulling out a cat ear headband. Catra saw it and ducked as Scorpia attempted to put it on her. "Gah!" she shrieked, running away as Scorpia chased her with the headband. She stopped to catch her breath, and Scorpia took the opportunity to put the headband on her, pull out her phone, and take a selfie with her. Catra did not resist, but looked grumpy. "There," she grumbled. "I'm wearing the stupid headband, now go put on something that looks like you weren't attacked by avocados."
Scorpia nodded and ran back into the bedroom. She came back a few minutes later in black heels, a black, backless dress, and her usual black lipstick. Catra nodded. "You look… nice. Kinda."
Scorpia giggled. "Thank you!"

Meanwhile, on the other side of town, Glimmer was looking in the mirror, carefully applying shiny, pink lipstick. Suddenly there was a yell.
"Glimmer, help!"
Glimmer dropped the lipstick and rushed to Adora's room, down the hall. She opened the door, dreading what might be happening in there-

Adora was lying on the floor, tangled up in a long pink dress with many layers. She looked up at Glimmer. "Help," she whispered. Glimmer smiled and shook her head, helping Adora up. "Have you never seen a dress before?" she joked. Adora looked down. "Well, not really... my mom didn't like that kind of thing...
"Oh. Well, you have me to help you now!" Glimmer said, smiling at her. "And I think pink isn't your color, and poofy isn't your style." She rummaged through the closet and pulled out a different garment. "Try this."

Later, it was time for the party. Glimmer, Bow and Adora all walked in together. Glimmer wore a floofy purple strappy dress, Bow wore a cream suit with a crop top, and Adora wore a long red dress with no sleeves and a turtleneck. The three of them wandered around chatting for a while, then Glimmer saw two people enter the room. An average-sized Latina girl in a red suit, and a large woman in a black dress. But Glimmer didn't care about the large woman - only the beautiful woman in the suit. "Just a sec," she excused herself, and went to talk to the beautiful girl as the large girl ran off to talk to someone else. "Hi," she said, smiling up at her. "What's your name?"
The woman paused, then replied, "Catra. You?"
They talked for a bit. Eventually, Catra offered to go get punch for the both of them. As she left, though, her suit's sleeve rode up, and Glimmer saw Catra's demon wings tattoo. "What on earth?" the girl thought aloud. "That's the Horde symbol." She followed Catra, and saw the other woman pull out a tiny bottle from her pocket and drip some liquid into one of the punch drinks. "What is that?" Glimmer wondered aloud, worriedly. She tried to think of what to do next, but Catra started to come back with the punch. "Here you go," she said, handing Glimmer one of the cups. Glimmer stared at it warily, as though the liquid could jump from the cup and attack her. Luckily, she was saved by Scorpia running up, enthusiastically saying, "Catra, guess what?? They have THE BEST SNACKS HERE!" As Scorpia chattered about the snacks, Glimmer looked at the drinks, which were sitting on a ledge now, and a crazy thought entered her head.
She picked up both drinks and switched them around.

A moment later, Catra had managed to get rid of Scorpia, and turned back to Glimmer.
"Umm, let's go over there," Glimmer suggested nervously, pointing at a corner of the room where nobody was. Catra obliged. As they continued talking, Catra sipped her drink. Suddenly, she swayed. "Why do I feel light-headed?" she asked, slurring her speech.
Glimmer froze, hoping this would work.
Catra swayed again and fell to the ground. Glimmer looked down at her, half proud and half sick over what she just did, and what she was about to do.
She grabbed Catra by the ankles and dragged her away.

Chapter End Notes

> And before you ask, NO SHE IS NOT ABOUT TO BECOME A R*PIST!!!!!!

Chapter 3

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Everything was dark. Catra opened her eyes. Everything was still dark. She became aware of the ball of paper towel stuffed in her mouth, as well as something that felt like fabric tied around her face and something uncomfortable tied around her hands and feet. She heard footsteps, and then the door opened. Light flooded in.
"You're awake," said a slightly annoyed girl's voice. "Good."
A backlit figure reached down, grabbed Catra and pulled her out of whatever dark space she had been in.
As the figure dragged her across the room, Catra's eyes adjusted to the light and she saw that the figure was a girl her age with pink hair. Glimmer. Catra's eyes widened as she remembered.
Walking in.
Glimmer approaching her.
Putting sedative in Glimmer's punch.
Scorpia interrupting.
Sipping her punch.
Dizziness.
Then black.
"Hey!" Glimmer snapped. "Are you listening to me?"
Catra stared at her in shock and anger. "You've kidnapped me! Why?"
"Because you tried to kidnap me," Glimmer answered, folding her arms. "And because you're from the Horde. Now tell me why you tried to kidnap me."
Catra shrugged. "Your mom's rich."
"You were going to hold me hostage??" Glimmer exclaimed angrily.
Catra decided to observe her bindings to avoid looking at Glimmer. Her legs and arms were bound with many necklace chains, and the tissues and pink scarf that had been used to gag her laid beside her on the arm of the chair.

Glimmer opened her mouth as if to ask another question, but realized she had forgotten what she was going to say, instead just looking at Catra. She realized she had been staring at her captive for a long time, and became flustered.
"You're going back in the closet," she said decisively. She stuffed the tissues into Catra's mouth and tied her pink scarf across the other girl's mouth for good measure, then dragged her back to the closet. Before she shut the door, Glimmer paused to say, "And don't worry. I'll bring you some food later." Then she shut the door and left, hoping nobody looked in her closet.
Catra sat in the dark with her eyes wide open.
Why had she gotten so embarrassed when she told Glimmer they'd planned to hold her hostage? Why had she been happy to know that Glimmer would be back later? And why did she remember enjoying talking to her at the party?
Catra sighed and curled up on her side. She would sleep until Glimmer came back.

Glimmer jogged down the hall, thinking of what to do if someone discovered Catra. She was so preoccupied, she didn't notice Adora walking toward her with her nose in her phone. They banged into each other. "Oh, sorry!" Adora apologized. "You okay?"
Glimmer didn't respond.
Adora waved a hand in front of her. "Earth to Glimmer, come in Glimmer."
Glimmer gasped in surprise, then shook her head. "Sorry, Adora. Thinking about… stuff."
Adora folded her arms and grinned. "So, who's the lucky girl or guy?"
"What??" Glimmer exclaimed. "What do you mean? What girl?"
Adora studied her, then smiled. "Okay, you don't have to tell me. For now."
"Well, what about you?" Glimmer asked. "Who are you texting?"
Adora smiled a bit. "This girl I met named Lonnie. She's really cool."
They talked about their lives for a bit, then Adora left. Glimmer thought about sitting in the living room and trying to text her other friends, but that idea went out the window when she walked

into the living room and saw Bow making out with his boyfriend, Sea Hawk (who always refused to be called by his real name, Smith) on the couch. Glimmer very carefully tiptoed out of the room so as not to disturb them. As soon as she was out of the room, she sighed. Why did all her friends have someone, but not her?

Chapter End Notes

Sorry it's a little short! My phone was acting up and I had to get it done fast.

Chapter 4

Chapter Notes

> I'm so sorry I'm late! I've been a lil busy lately, but I'm here now!

A few hours later, Glimmer opened the closet door again. She ungagged a sleeping Catra. "Wake up," she said, lightly shoving her. The other girl opened her eyes, blinking a few times as she got used to the light. "You're gonna yell at me some more?" Catra asked, half-awake but already sassy.

Glimmer shook her head. "No. I brought food, though."

"I can't exactly eat it like this, can I?" Catra said, holding up her arms, which were still bound with necklace chains.

"I know," Glimmer replied. "I'm gonna untie you. But don't try anything." She unwrapped the necklace chains from Catra's arms and legs. Catra stood up and stretched. Glimmer grabbed a small tray, which had some healthy snacks and a water bottle, and handed it to Catra without taking her eyes off her. "You can sit there," she said, pointing to a light pink armchair in the corner. Catra sat down and ate as Glimmer watched her.

"Sorry there isn't much," she apologized awkwardly. "My mom can't know about this, or we'll both be in trouble."

Catra paused as she was about to bite a celery stick. "What'll she do?"

"Oh, she'll probably yell at me and call the cops on you," Glimmer explained. "You know, about what you'd expect. Why?"

Catra nodded absently. "My mom used to beat me and my sister."

"O-oh," Glimmer said, looking down sadly. "I… I'm so sorry that happened to you."

"It's all right," the other girl said.

"What happened to your sister?" Glimmer asked, hoping to get to a lighter subject.

"Mental hospital," Catra answered. "Our trauma really messed her up. Me, not so much, but… it's there."

There was silence for a few seconds. Then Catra realized what she just told Glimmer. "Wait, why did I tell you that? I don't even know you! You kidnapped me! I-"

Glimmer hugged her. Catra gasped. She hugged her back for a few seconds. Then she pushed Glimmer away. "All right, that's enough affectionate stuff for now."

She finished eating. Neither girl spoke. Once Catra was done, Glimmer put her bindings back on and put her back in the closet. She felt slightly guilty about it this time, though. She decided to go for a walk and think about just what she planned to do with Catra. While Glimmer was getting ready to go out, Adora walked in, chatting happily with a short, brown-skinned girl. They stopped when they noticed Glimmer.

"Oh, hi, Glimmer!" Adora said cheerfully. "This is Lonnie, the girl I told you about! Lonnie, this is Glimmer. She's my best friend."

Lonnie looked at Glimmer. "Hi," she said coolly. "I recognize you from my mother's rich people gossip magazines."

"Oh, really?" Glimmer offered, unsure of how to respond to that.

"Questionable hair choices by the way," Lonnie added.

Adora laughed nervously. "Okay! We are gonna go hang out in the living room now! Bye!" She grabbed Lonnie's hand and pulled her through the door.

Glimmer went outside and stared up at the sky as she contemplated what to do with Catra.

Let her go? No. That would be much too complicated.

Hold her hostage? Maybe. They could get information at least, if not important people. But the police would have something to say about the kidnapping.

Kill her? Never. Glimmer didn't want something like that on her conscience, and besides - although she hated the fact, she liked Catra. She was a cool girl. Maybe they could've been friends under different circumstances.

Glimmer sighed. She didn't know what to do.

Catra sat in the dark closet, blushing hard in embarrassment. Why had she told Glimmer about her mother and sister? That was personal, and she had told not only a complete stranger, but a stranger who kidnapped her! What was wrong with her lately?

Catra sighed. Even though it had only been the previous night that she'd seen her, she missed Scorpia like crazy. They were best friends, despite all the time she'd spent telling her that they weren't friends at all. When she got back, maybe they'd be able to go see a movie or something together.

Catra hoped she'd be able to go home soon.

Glimmer came back inside. She leaned against the door and sighed, then went into the kitchen. She found their housekeeper, Juliet, washing dishes. "Hi, Juliet," Glimmer said, leaning against the counter.

"Hello, Glimmer," Juliet replied, rinsing a dish and putting it in the dishrack. "How are you?"

Glimmer thought about what to say, eventually settling on, "Fine, thanks." She wished that this was true, and that she wasn't nauseous from the stress of figuring out what to do about Catra.

Chapter 5

Catra was still in the closet. She had been thinking about her unexplainable trust of Glimmer, the fact that her heart beat faster whenever she saw her, the embarrassment she felt about trying to kidnap her. Catra had come to the conclusion that she was badly sick. Perhaps she'd caught something from Glimmer. But it didn't matter. Catra was going to break out of here. She'd get out, go home and get to see Scorpia again. She could get back to her life - roasting Scorpia, yelling at Kyle, arguing with Hordak. Everything would be perfect.

Glimmer slipped quietly out of Adora's bedroom. She had been talking to Adora and Lonnie, but then they started making out and Glimmer refused to deal with that.

Glimmer was taking a break from dealing with Catra. As she went back to her room, she yawned, tired. Glimmer collapsed on the bed and stayed there.

She dreamed about Catra.

Glimmer woke up on her bed, on top of the covers. Lying next to her was Catra. Glimmer shook Catra awake gently.

"What is it, dummy?" Catra asked.

"I love you," Glimmer said, smiling. Catra smiled back. "I love you too."

She kissed Glimmer.

Glimmer woke up. She rubbed her eyes and yawned. Then she remembered her dream and blushed bright red, curling into an embarrassed ball. She refused to have a crush on Catra! Catra was her enemy, and currently her captive. And nobody fell in love with their enemies in real life.

Later, Glimmer's mother came home from work. This was a rare occurrence; Anngella barely ever came home. Glimmer was texting Mermista when she heard Angella's voice downstairs. She immediately ran to the kitchen - and saw something she never thought she'd see in her life.

Her mother, kissing Juliet the housekeeper.

Glimmer gasped. The two women immediately separated, both looking slightly embarrassed.

"Glimmer, I'm ho-" Angella started to say.

But Glimmer turned and ran.

She ran upstairs to her room. This was too much of a change. This couldn't happen, not now. Not when she already had so much on her plate.

Angela came upstairs and knocked on the door. "Glimmer?"

Glimmer growled a bit.

"Glimmer, we need to talk." Angela opened the door.

"Look," she began quietly. "I know this must be strange for you - me dating someone, even so long after your father died in the Police force. But… sometimes, you need to follow your heart, and not your head."

Glimmer was still silent. Angela sighed. "Glimmer, I hope you can come to terms with this news. I'm sorry, but I will not leave her."

And with that, Angella walked away.

Glimmer lay there, thinking about her mother's words, and her dream.

"...Sometimes you need to follow your heart…"

"...I love you…."

Glimmer sat up. She had made a decision. She got up and ran to the closet.

"Get up," she said to Catra, yanking her out of the closet.

"What-"

"Shh!"

And she started untying Catra.

Chapter 6

Catra stared at Glimmer. "What are you doing?"
"I'm letting you go," Glimmer answered. "Now let's just get you downstairs and out of here before anyone sees you. Come on." She grabbed Catra by her hand and pulled her down the hallway. They nearly ran right into Bow and Sea Hawk, who were wandering around as Sea Hawk told Bow a no-doubt-exaggerated story about his favorite subject - himself. "Oh, hi Glimmer," Bow said. "Sea Hawk was telling me a story! Oh, who's this?" Catra froze.
"Um, this is... Catherine!" Glimmer said, thinking fast. "I met her at, um… the mall! But she's leaving now." She pulled Catra away. The boys shrugged and kept talking.
"Thanks, Glimmer," Catra said quietly once they were out of earshot. "I froze back there, and it was a good thing you stepped in."
"Thank you, Catra," Glimmer said happily. Her tone quickly changed to teasing. "Hey, you were really nice just then! Guess you're not such a big, tough alley cat after all."
Catra scoffed. "Whatever. It's not because I like you or anything."
Glimmer smiled, but didn't say a word.
Glimmer and Catra managed to get to the front door without any more trouble.
"Well, here's the door," Glimmer said, a bit sadly.
"Oh really? I thought it was a catfish," Catra said sarcastically, but she was smiling.
Glimmer smiled back. "Have a good life, Catra."
Glimmer opened the door.
Thunder crashed.
Catra squealed and grabbed onto Glimmer. Glimmer closed the door and smirked. "Afraid of thunder, huh?"
Catra immediately let go of her. "What? No!" Glimmer laughed. "Well, it's raining tonight, so it looks like you can't leave til tomorrow."
"Then where am I going to sleep?" Catra asked.

"No. Oh, no. Not in a million years."
Catra folded her arms and shook her head. "I'm not sharing a bed with you!"
"Catra, it'll be fine!" Glimmer said. She was wearing a pink nightie with "Sweet Dreams" written on it in glitter. "You can sleep on one side of the bed and I'll sleep on the other! Now go behind the screen and put this on." She thrust a red nightie with a glittery chibi cat on it at Catra, who reluctantly took it and went to change.
As she was changing, Glimmer sat on the bed and stared at the wall. She felt completely and utterly nauseous at the idea of sharing a bed with Catra, even for one night. How would she ever survive the awkwardness?
Behind the screen, Catra was having similar thoughts, with slightly less nausea.
Stupid rain. Why did it have to storm tonight? Now she was gonna have to share a bed with Glimmer! Could anything be more embarrassing than sleeping next to someone with such stupid hair? Not to mention her kidnapper!
But then, she did have those beautiful eyes… and purple was such a rare color, too…
Catra shook her head. She would never allow herself to think about this.
Catra pulled on the nightie and came out from behind the screen. She got into the bed on the opposite side from where Glimmer was sitting. "Night, I guess," Catra muttered.
Glimmer paused. "Night, Catra." She turned out the light and got into the bed too.
They lay there in silence for a while, both listening to the rain falling outside. Then thunder crashed again. Catra squealed and curled into a ball. Glimmer noticed. "You okay?" she asked.
"Yes," Catra said defiantly. "Maybe." She paused. "No..."
Glimmer smiled at the girl's attitude. "I could maybe hold onto you, if you'd like… so you won't be scared…"
Catra hesitated - then went over to Glimmer's side of the bed and hugged her. Glimmer hugged Catra back, smiling without even realizing it. And the next time thunder roared outside, neither of them flinched.

The next morning, they were still entangled in each other's arms, asleep, when Juliet came into the bedroom. "Ahem. Glimmer, I believe it's time to wake up- What? Glimmer, who's this?"
Both girls looked sleepily up at her - Then their eyes widened identically, and they looked at each other. The thoughts that went through their minds were also exactly the same.
Uh-oh.

Chapter 7

The girls both stared up at Juliet. "I can explain," Glimmer said quickly. "Um, we… she…"

"Look, I'm not going to judge you for this, Glimmer," Juliet said. "But I do have to tell your mother. She needs to know, so she can talk to you. And so that I won't have to sleep on the couch. Now, I'll let you get dressed." She left the room.

Catra and Glimmer looked at each other, wide-eyed.

"Well, that was a great plan," Catra said sarcastically. "Got any others to get your mom off our backs?"

"I'll figure something out," Glimmer said. "Look. You can go now. The storm's let up, and it's morning. So… I'll show you the door."

She and Catra went downstairs to the front door.

"Well, I guess this is it," Glimmer said.

"Yeah," Catra answered, looking away.

Glimmer took a deep breath. "Goodbye, Catra. I'll never forget you."

"Bye, dummy," Catra muttered.

She opened the door and left, only briefly looking back.

Glimmer closed the door and sighed, leaning against it. Catra was gone. All Glimmer had to do now was come up with a convincing story for Angella and she'd be fine.

So why did she have this sinking feeling in her chest?

Catra walked down the street. It was the first time she'd been outside in almost a week. She stared at everything around her.

The sun burned her eyes, but it was worth it. Catra was free at last.

So why did it feel so wrong?

A bit later, Glimmer and Angella sat in the living room. Glimmer had been called there by her mother and was trying not to make eye contact.

"Glimmer, Juliet told me that she found you and another girl asleep in your bed this morning," Angella said, calmly but with an undercurrent of annoyance.

Glimmer was silent, looking away.

Angela's tone and expression softened. "I'm not angry. I know that you are eighteen, and this is going to happen. I just want to know who this young woman was."

Glimmer's head jerked up. "Mom, no! We weren't… We aren't girlfriends!"

"Glimmer, it's okay," Angella said quietly. "I will not judge you. You can tell me the truth."

Glimmer paused. "...You promise you won't get mad?"

Angella nodded.

Glimmer took a deep breath. "Well, this is a really, really long story…"

Catra looked at the apartment door. She took a deep breath, straightening her bow tie.

This was it. Catra was finally going home. She smoothed her hair back and knocked on the door. Scorpia answered it. She started to say a casual hello, then realized who it was. She stared down at Catra with a face of shock and wonder. And then the shrieking began

"CATRA!!!" Scorpia yelled happily, grabbing the smaller girl in a big hug and spinning her around. "Let go of me!" Catra sputtered indignantly. Scorpia put Catra down. "What happened? Where were you? How are you here? Tell me everything! Oh my God, I am so glad you're okay…"

Catra waited until she was done, then cleared her throat. "So, um… about what happened…"

"...And so I opened the door, and let her go," Glimmer finished. She waited nervously for Angella's reaction.

Angela's expression was difficult to read. She seemed to be looking at a point far away. She nodded.

"I see," Angella said quietly.

She stood up, pulling out her phone. She dialed a number.

"Hello, Etheria Police Department," said a cheerful voice.

Glimmer gasped. "Mom, no!" She jumped up and attempted to grab the phone. Angella held it above her head. "Glimmer, you know I have to."

Glimmer jumped, trying to grab the phone and internally cursing her short stature. Angella left the room with Glimmer still trying to get the phone. Glimmer chased her mother all the way to the car, whose door Angella closed and locked before Glimmer could get in.

Glimmer was forced to back away so as not to get hurt as Angella started pulling away.

She watched her mother drive away, helpless to do anything else.

"...so then she opened the door, and I walked away," Catra finished.

Scorpia stared at Catra. "Whoa." She stuttered a bit, shaking her head. "I- whoa. That's so awful, and cool, and terrifying, a-all at the same time." There was a pause. "So… what are we gonna do now?"

Catra shrugged. "Go back to our lives, what else? We gotta figure out how to deal with Hordak being mad at us, but how's that different from normal?"

Scorpia kept chattering as Catra walked around, doing things.

Neither of them knew that the police had already been called…

Chapter 8

Glimmer burst into her room. She grabbed a large pink purse and threw her toothbrush, phone and a few other essential things into it. She threw on a hoodie and ran downstairs. She bumped into Adora, and ran right past her without an apology.

There was no time for an apology..

Adora stared after Glimmer as she ran off. Why was she in such a hurry?

Only one way to find out.

Adora ran off after Glimmer.

Glimmer barreled downstairs. She stopped briefly to write down a note, then kept running to the front door.

Adora picked up the note and read it.

"Dear Mom, Bow, Adora and Juliet. I have left. I do not want to be arrested. I am sorry. Goodbye."

Glimmer ran out through the front door and down the sidewalk. She eventually slowed to a walk out of tiredness. Glimmer sighed - why had she not been born able to teleport? It would be so much easier!

She eventually made it to her destination- a Starbucks. That was a good place to sit and think. What could she do?

The line was very long. Glimmer's foot tapped impatiently. She didn't have time for this!

When It was finally her turn to order, Glimmer first smiled at the barista. "Hi, Spinnerella!" she said cheerfully to the plump, purple-haired woman behind the counter. Spinnerella smiled back. "Hello,

Glimmer! It's wonderful to see you as always. But why aren't you with your friends? It's the weekend!"

Glimmer looked away. "It's, um… complicated."

Spinnerella looked like she was about to say something, but she was interrupted by another woman, who had dark skin with short blue hair and was pounding on one of the many dispensers, swearing (moderately) quietly.

"I'm sorry about Netossa," Spinnerella apologized instead of whatever she was going to say before. "I'll go calm her down. Oh, by the way what's your order?"

Glimmer ordered her drink and Spinnerella rushed off to make it (and calm down her wife, who was still reprimanding the coffee machine.)

Glimmer got her drink and went to her usual table. When she sat down, she squeaked a bit - Adora was sitting across from her. Glimmer laughed nervously. "Oh. Hi, Adora…"

Catra was standing on the balcony, looking out across the city. She was thinking about the time she'd spent in Glimmer's closet. While she didn't miss the closet, she missed Glimmer a bit. Only a little, though! Glimmer was not important. But Catra still had trouble adjusting to being home. It would get better, after all it hadn't been very long since she got home, but it still felt… alien.

This apartment had a lot of memories attached. Catra and Scorpia had been living there for a year. When they first moved in, Scorpia's mother had just died. Her other mom died when Scorpia was four. The apartment was technically Scorpia's - when her mother died Scorpia wanted to move to somewhere with no memories of her.

Around this time, Catra was starting to get really fed up with her own mother. Catra was a few years younger than Scorpia, and had been only seventeen. Her mother had been abusing and manipulating her for years, and Catra had finally gotten so fed up

with it that she stormed out one day and never went back. Scorpia let Catra stay with her for a while. A while had eventually turned into forever, and here they were.

Wouldn't it be great if Glimmer could join their tiny family…

"What are you doing, Glimmer?" Adora asked her friend with a serious face. "Why would you be arrested, and why are you running away?"

Glimmer froze - then, took a deep breath and explained everything.

Chapter 9

"So you kidnapped this girl?" Adora said, astonished. "And you just… let her go? Without telling anyone about it? Even the police?"
"Yeah, pretty much," Glimmer answered with a small shrug. "Then I had to tell Mom, and she called the cops on me."
Adora paused to think for a moment. Then, she said, "Okay. We'll get you through this, Glimmer. You're not going to jail. And this Catra girl - you like her, right?"
Glimmer spat her coffee all over the table, Adora and herself. "What?? No!"
"Uh-huh. We'll find you her address and number, you can tell her everything, and then you might even wind up going on a date or canoodling later…" Adora's tone was light and teasing, but Glimmer's face was bright red. "No!"

Catra was lying on the couch, with her face in a cushion. Scorpia came into the room. She sat down on the edge of the couch. "Catra?" she asked gently. The younger girl groaned and lifted her head briefly to growl "What?"
"You okay?" Scorpia asked.
Catra was silent for a moment.
"Yeah," she said curtly.
"Are you su-"
"I SAID I'M FINE!"
Scorpia drew back. "Um, ok. If you're sure…" She went into the tiny kitchen to start making supper.
Catra groaned and put her face back in the cushion. Life was too complicated.
Her phone suddenly rang.
Catra growled and slapped at the screen, trying to hang up.
"Hello?" Glimmer said from the other end of the phone.
Catra jumped in surprise. She must've hit answer by accident. She almost hung up- but she was curious. "H-hi?" she said into the phone.
"Catra!" Glimmer exclaimed happily.

Catra smiled to herself, but forced her mouth's corners down. "Yeah. How'd you get my number?"
"It was in the phone book. You have a unique name - there was only one Catra Miao in there. But I have something important to tell you."
Catra listened. As Glimmer told the story, Catra's expression became angry, and so did her voice.
"You told your mom WHAT?" she said, quietly but angrily.
"I'm so sorry," Glimmer said, sounding like she was going to cry. "But she's my mom, I had to…"
Catra paused, her whole body shaking. "No you didn't," she said, her voice shaking as much as the rest of her. "And now we're both in huge trouble. And it is all. Your. Fault."
She hung up.

Glimmer heard the hang-up beep and put her phone down, eyes filling with tears. Adora ran over to hug her.
And Glimmer cried on Adora's shoulder. "W-what have I done?" she asked through her tears.
Adora kept holding her. "It's okay," she said softly. "We're gonna figure this out. Why don't we go talk to her in person?"
Glimmer sniffled. She thought about it for a long time, then finally said, "Yeah."

Scorpia came out of the kitchen with two plates. She sat down beside Catra, who was staring at the floor. "Um, Catra?"
"What?" Catra asked, her voice cold.
"I made fish," Scorpia said tentatively. "Would you like yours now, or should I put it in the fridge?"
"I don't care," Catra said. "I'm going to bed."
"But it's only five-thirty-"
"I'm going to bed, Scorpia." Catra got up and went into the bedroom.
Scorpia stared after her sadly. She had missed Catra, but Catra didn't want to talk to her at all.
In the bedroom, Catra collapsed onto the bed, not bothering to remove her contacts or even undress. She was only eighteen, and already tired of life.
Catra began to cry as she lay there. Why had life dealt her such

an unfair hand? First she had to deal with her mother's abuse as a child. Then, a few years ago, her twin sister lost her mind and got locked up. Now the police were after Catra herself.
A few years leaked from her eyes, and quickly turned into a waterfall flowing down her face. Catra grabbed her pillow and screamed into it several times, before curling up on her side, holding the pillow like a teddy bear.
She would sleep until she had no choice but to get up.

Chapter 10

Glimmer looked at Adora. "Are you sure this will work?"
Adora nodded enthusiastically.
There was a pause.
"Okay, fine. No I'm not. But what do we have to lose?"
The girls went into the elevator. The two stood there in silence, Glimmer leaning on Adora and Adora holding Glimmer.
They finally reached Catra's floor. Glimmer followed Adora down the hall.
"11, 12… 13! Here we are. Am I good, or am I good?" Adora tried to strike a cool pose here, but utterly failed. It did make them both laugh a bit.
"Do you want to knock on the door?" Adora asked quietly.
Glimmer hesitated- then nodded.
She raised her hand and knocked tentatively on the door.

Catra lay in bed, half-asleep. She felt numb and empty. Everything seemed… cold, and far away. Even Scorpia's humming along to "Girls Like Girls" in the living room sounded faded.
The doorbell rang. Scorpia answered it.
"Oh, hi! Who are you guys? … Oh, okay. I think she's asleep, but you can come in and wait for her to wake up!"
Catra briefly wondered who it was, but then drifted back into the cold haze. Then, she heard a familiar voice.
"Thank you," Glimmer said, her voice sounding far away.
Catra's ears perked up, and she got out of bed. She quickly looked in the mirror.
Her hair was a bit messy.
She smoothed it down, then went into the living room.
Sure enough, Glimmer was there. There was also a blonde girl with her hair in a ponytail. Scorpia was showing them something on her phone.
"...And this is me and my girlfriend Perfuma at her drum circle last summer! Oh wow, that was a great day. Let me tell you!..."
Catra hadn't known Scorpia had a girlfriend.
She suddenly felt a stab of guilt for not talking to her roommate

more often. As often as Catra denied it, Scorpia was her friend. Her best friend, in fact. But Catra couldn't claim to be anyone's best friend herself.
Wait, Perfuma? Like Perfuma Alexander? How had Scorpia landed a famous actress, while Catra was still single??
"Oh, that sounds cool," Glimmer said, trying to sound interested but looking off into space. She saw Catra peeking into the room. She waved awkwardly. "Hi," she called uncertainly.
Catra paused, then slipped into the room and sat down on the couch, shoulders hunched. She had worn black that day - a black tank-top with dark red jeanshorts and black stockings. It was supposed to make her look intimidating, but she didn't look intimidating at all now.
Adora and Scorpia exchanged a look.
"So, um, Adora! That's your name, right?"
Adora nodded.
"Let's go see the rest of the apartment, okay?"
Adora caught on. "Um- yeahhh, let's do that!"
The two of them forced giant grins as they left the room, leaving Glimmer and Catra alone.
The girls sat at opposite ends of the couch, each briefly glancing at the other before looking away again.
Finally, Glimmer broke the silence.
"So, uh… I'm sorry."
Catra stiffened, but didn't move.
Glimmer continued. "I was weak. I shouldn't have told my mom, or I should've at least tried harder to convince her not to report us."
"Yes, you should've," Catra agreed.
There was silence.
"Look, Catra, I-"
And that's when Catra blew up.
"QUIT TRYING TO SAY YOU'RE SORRY!" she yelled. "SORRY WON'T FIX ANYTHING! YOU KEPT ME IN A CLOSET FOR THREE DAYS! AND I'M GOING TO JAIL BECAUSE OF YOUR MOTHER! AND YOU KNOW THE WORST PART? THE WORST PART IS THAT I CAN'T STOP THINKING ABOUT YOUR STUPID FACE-" She stopped, and her voice broke on the next sentence. "And your

stupid smile, and your stupid eyes, and…"
She stopped. Only for a split second.
And then she kissed Glimmer.
Glimmer's eyes widened - and then she kissed Catra back.
Adora and Scorpia, who had been walking back into the room, froze.
Catra pulled away from Glimmer. "I- I'm sorry," she muttered.
"Uh, n-no," Glimmer said, still in shock. "It's all right. I, uh… I've been thinking about it, and I think there might be a possibility that I might… like you. A lot. So…"
And then she kissed Catra.
Adora and Scorpia smiled at each other.
Glimmer pulled away and smiled at Catra.
"We can do this."

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